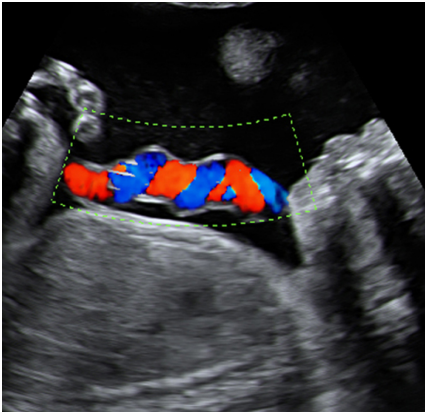




YOU ARE **32 WEEKS EXACTLY**
56 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The blood flow in the umbilical cord is highlighted in this image. The colors show the direction of flow. The smaller umbilical arteries that carry blood toward the placenta are seen in blue as they wrap around the more central umbilical vein (in red).

“The best way to make sure you get enough sleep is to find ways to slow down mentally and relax.”

You may be having difficulty sleeping, partly because your belly makes it uncomfortable to lie down in certain positions, but also because you have lots to think about. Try to take some time out with your partner relaxing and bonding together with your belly. Even 10 minutes doing nothing except focusing on yourself, your body, your partner, and your baby can be invigorating and rejuvenating.

At night, try to get yourself into a comfortable position, and then focus inward on your body, turning your mind away from all your external worries. First focus on slowing down your breathing. Then think about a place and a time when you felt relaxed and happy—for example, on vacation, walking on the beach. Next focus on clenching and then relaxing each set of muscles in turn, or imagine a ball of heat passing slowly through your limbs and body making them feel warm, heavy, and relaxed.

You might want to involve your partner, perhaps they could lie with you with their hands or head on your belly and try to adjust their breathing so it's in sync with yours. Just lying next to your partner can relax you and bring you close together.

DRESSING FOR EXERCISE

In this last trimester, dressing comfortably for exercise can make all the difference to you feel. Be sure you are wearing the correct size—trying to squeeze into clothes you outgrew three months ago will be uncomfortable and restricting and may make breathing difficult. There are exercise clothes designed specifically for pregnancy, but you can also just wear a large T-shirt and tracksuit bottoms or loose-fitting shorts.

Support belts may make cardiovascular exercise more comfortable. Most are made from elasticized fabric with Velcro fastenings that can be adjusted to suit your belly size. These belts, available at many maternity stores, are inexpensive and can help ease back pain, too.

Wearing a well-fitting sports bra is vital for any activity as the delicate breast tissue can weaken due to the increased pressure of your larger and heavier breasts. If your breasts are very